

Social Studies – District – Elementary
2024 Governor's Cup Competition



1. This Kentucky geographic region was the first to be settled by Europeans, probably because of the fertile soils there. Thoroughbred horses are associated with what Kentucky region below that includes the cities of Frankfort, Lexington and Louisville?
 - A. Bluegrass
 - B. Eastern Coal Fields
 - C. Pennyrile
 - D. Jackson Purchase
2. Sometimes referred to as the “Niagara of the South,” Cumberland Falls features one of only two naturally occurring predictable events of this type on earth—the other is Victoria Falls. What is this natural event that brings tourists to this landmark near Corbin, Kentucky?
 - A. lunar eclipse
 - B. moonbow
 - C. landslides
 - D. waterfall
3. What Kentucky geographic region is shaded in the picture shown?
 - A. Pennyrile
 - B. Western Coal Fields
 - C. Knobs
 - D. Jackson Purchase
4. A Kentucky State Park in Madison County is found on the site where this frontiersman established a settlement in 1775. Which explorer below helped build the Wilderness Road from Virginia through Kentucky for the Transylvania Company?
 - A. Davy Crockett
 - B. James Audubon
 - C. Daniel Boone
 - D. George Rogers Clark
5. He lends his name to both a city and county in Central Kentucky. Which man below served as Kentucky’s governor from 1792 to 1796 and from 1812 to 1816?
 - A. George Madison
 - B. James Garrard
 - C. Isaac Shelby
 - D. Charles Scott
6. This U.S. state was the 49th to be admitted to the Union, in 1959. It has more land area than any other state. In or near what state below can you find the Aleutian Islands, Denali National Park, the Seward National Park and the Bering Strait?
 - A. Hawaii
 - B. Alaska
 - C. California
 - D. Texas



7. On the compass rose pictured, what intermediate direction is indicated by the star?
- A. Southwest
 - B. Southeast
 - C. Northwest
 - D. Northeast



8. A National Park here makes up the largest subtropical wilderness in the United States. It's known for alligators and, recently, non-native released pets like Burmese pythons. What is this wetland area in Florida of some 1.5 million acres?
- A. Everglades
 - B. Okefenokee
 - C. Chesapeake Bay
 - D. Upper Mississippi River
9. This environmental hazard results from the burning of fossil fuels. It can lead to the decline of aquatic life and damage soil and trees. In the U.S., the 1970 Clean Air Act and other legislation have successfully reduced the impact of what harmful process?
- A. deforestation
 - B. methane emissions
 - C. acid rain
 - D. erosion
10. Shown is Farmer Sue's planting schedule for the next few years. What beneficial farming practice is Sue using?

Planting Schedule	
Year	Plant
2024	Corn
2025	Oats
2026	Clover

- A. pest management
 - B. soil preparation
 - C. contour plowing
 - D. crop rotation
11. Today, the majority of immigrants to the United States are from other countries in North and South America. Which choice below describes the place of origin of the majority of immigrants from 1900 to 1940?
- A. Western Europe
 - B. India
 - C. East Asia
 - D. Russia
12. Like many other explorers, this Englishman was trying to find a shortcut to Asia from Europe through the Arctic. He sailed aboard the Half Moon. What explorer below has both a river and a bay in New York state named after him?
- A. John Cabot
 - B. Henry Hudson
 - C. Martin Frobisher
 - D. Sir Walter Raleigh

13. Which Founding Father below represented the U.S. in France, advanced knowledge of electricity, helped write the Constitution, and wrote *Poor Richard's Almanack*?
- A. Thomas Jefferson
 - B. Benjamin Franklin
 - C. James Madison
 - D. John Hancock
14. Even though the explorer below is most closely associated with the Fountain of Youth, it is now believed finding it was not the main reason for his travels. Which explorer below is credited with being the first European to reach Florida?
- A. Hernando de Soto
 - B. Giovanni da Verrazzano
 - C. Ponce de Leon
 - D. Pedro Menéndez de Avilés
15. The original version of this document has never been found. It was the first governmental document of its type adopted in what is now the United States, and it was signed aboard a ship. The final section of which document below ends "*Anno Domini 1620*?"
- A. Mayflower Compact
 - B. Magna Carta
 - C. Constitution
 - D. Declaration of Independence
16. This officer served the Continental Army during the American Revolution until he switched his loyalty to the British. Because of this, whose name is now a synonym for "traitor"?
- A. Benedict Arnold
 - B. Ethan Allen
 - C. George Armstrong Custer
 - D. Marquis de Lafayette
17. In December 1773, American patriots disguised as Native Americans secretly boarded ships in Boston Harbor. Their goal was to protest British trade practices and taxes. What commodity did they throw into the harbor, which lends its name to a so-called "party" that now describes the event?
- A. gunpowder
 - B. gold
 - C. salt
 - D. tea
18. This ship was the setting for a 1997 film by James Cameron. What supposedly unsinkable ship, on its maiden voyage from England to New York City, hit an iceberg and sank in the Atlantic Ocean on April 15, 1912?
- A. Queen Elizabeth II
 - B. USS Maine
 - C. RMS Lusitania
 - D. RMS Titanic
19. The Native American chief shown in the image united the Sioux tribes in an attempt to defend themselves against the U.S. Army. Who successfully defeated Lt. Col. George A. Custer and his troops at the Battle of the Little Bighorn?
- A. Tecumseh
 - B. Sitting Bull
 - C. Geronimo
 - D. Chief Joseph



20. Kentucky, Massachusetts, Pennsylvania, and Virginia are all states, but they call themselves by a special name that signifies that they exist to serve the people who live there. What is that name?
- A. Republic
 - B. Democracy
 - C. Federalist
 - D. Commonwealth
21. The State of the Union speech is usually given during the first part of the calendar year. Typically, items discussed in the speech include the federal budget, the economy, and other timely news. Which office-holder below gives this speech?
- A. Speaker of the House
 - B. Senate Majority Leader
 - C. President
 - D. Secretary of State
22. This local office holder is typically in charge of arresting criminals, issuing warrants, enforcing traffic laws, and providing security for county court proceedings. Which office below can have deputies who help with the tasks above?
- A. sheriff
 - B. county clerk
 - C. mayor
 - D. council member
23. The 19th Constitutional Amendment was passed by Congress in 1919 and ratified in 1920. Jane Addams and Susan B. Anthony were important leaders in passing this Amendment, which helped gain what people below the right to vote in American elections?
- A. Native Americans
 - B. African Americans
 - C. 18-year-olds
 - D. women
24. Traditionally, there are 12 members of this group involved in the legal process. Types of this group include the “grand” type, which listens to evidence and decides whether or not a person should go on trial for a crime. What is the name of this legal body?
- A. jury
 - B. chamber
 - C. indictment
 - D. panel
25. In economics, what do we call a company that makes or manufactures something?
- A. consumer
 - B. distributor
 - C. producer
 - D. advertiser
26. Which economics term below can be simply described as “the amount of a particular product or service that is available to be sold” at a given time?
- A. demand
 - B. supply
 - C. opportunity cost
 - D. surplus

27. Which woman below, according to family stories, helped George Washington design, and then made, the first U.S. flag?
- A. Lucretia Mott
 - B. Abigail Adams
 - C. Betsy Ross
 - D. Phillis Wheatley
28. Which president below's likeness is NOT found on Mount Rushmore, which is shown in the image?
- A. Abraham Lincoln
 - B. George Washington
 - C. Thomas Jefferson
 - D. John F. Kennedy
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29. The COVID-19 pandemic, caused by what was called the novel coronavirus, was declared a pandemic by the World Health Organization in March 2020. In what country did the most widespread novel coronavirus probably originate, in a city called Wuhan?
- A. China
 - B. Japan
 - C. Mexico
 - D. India
30. She graduated Harvard with honors and a degree in Government, and went on to Harvard Law School. Who became America's first African-American woman on the Supreme Court in 2022?
- A. Sandra Day O'Connor
 - B. Ruth Bader Ginsburg
 - C. Ketanji Brown Jackson
 - D. Sonia Sotomayor

TIEBREAKERS

31. A series of natural disasters occurred in 1811 and 1812 that are named after New Madrid, a city in Missouri, just across the Mississippi River from Kentucky. What were those events?
- A. earthquakes
 - B. floods
 - C. tornadoes
 - D. hailstorms
32. It is believed that the religion known as voodoo combines Roman Catholic and African traditions. A traditional belief in this system is that everything is a spirit. With what country below is voodoo particularly associated?
- A. France
 - B. Mexico
 - C. Peru
 - D. Haiti

33. Which Native American below served as interpreter and a valuable guide for the Lewis and Clark expedition in the early 1800s?
- A. Pocahontas
 - B. Sacagawea
 - C. Metacomet
 - D. Chief Joseph
34. With what U.S. military conflict below are the following items associated?
- Gulf of Tonkin incident
 - Stopping the spread of communism
 - Anti-war protests in America
 - Burning draft cards
 - Ho Chi Minh
 - Tet Offensive
 - Hanoi
- A. Korea
 - B. Vietnam
 - C. World War II
 - D. Desert Storm
35. The market for these economic products experienced a crash in 1929. They are “exchanged” in New York City on Wall Street. What term below refers to so-called “shares” you can buy that represent the percentage of a company you own through their purchase?
- A. dividends
 - B. funds
 - C. lien
 - D. stocks
36. Which phrase below completes Kentucky’s official motto? United we stand, _____.
- A. forever
 - B. divided we fall
 - C. we can do no other
 - D. working together for the common good

**Elementary Governor's Cup
District Social Studies
Answer Key**

1. A
2. B
3. D
4. C
5. C
6. B
7. C
8. A
9. C
10. D
11. A
12. B
13. B
14. C
15. A
16. A
17. D
18. D
19. B

20. D
21. C
22. A
23. D
24. A
25. C
26. B
27. C
28. D
29. A
30. C
31. A
32. D
33. B
34. B
35. D
36. B